

Figure 10.11 Method of Draping

- Place the dress form on to a stand or table and ensure it is steady.
- Select the fabric, which has to be cut and stitched. Drape the fabric on the individual, look of design and colour to match the individual's structure and complexion.
- Beginners can first drape with fabric which is of similar texture and weight to the fabric, which is to be cut and sewed.
- Drape the fabric on the dress form allow it to fall naturally. Check the grain of the fabric (lengthwise grain should match the centre front line). A number of experimental folds have to be made. Check for best design and drape. Pin the extra fabric. Do not cut.
- Ensure the design and drape once again, so as to avoid cutting on wrong size or designs.
- Draping should be done on a continuous line to give the best effect. This is possible only through practice. Hence before finalizing the design and pattern try draping in a number of ways.
- Special care should be taken in case of checks and stripes. These fabrics can be draped on cross grain also for creating design variation, especially for yoke or collar.
- To decide on fullness, try 2 to 3 styles. Example, pin tucks, box pleats and gathers can be draped on the dress form and the best can be selected.
- Once the design of the garment is finalized pin the fabric on the dress form, match the centre front, back, shoulder, chest round lines to that in the dress form. Pin along the line.
- Move the fingers slowly and make the dart and fullness needed and pin it. Care should be taken to maintain grain.
- Mark the line, cut and keep the pieces ready for sewing.
- Name the pieces to avoid confussion. Fold the piece and keep them in a neat cover, if stitching is not being done immediately.
- For identical design one side can be draped, marked and cut. The reverse of the cut patterns can be used for preparing the pattern for the other side.
- Care should be taken to use minimum or fine pins especially for delicate fabrics like silk.
- Based upon the type of design, dart can be converted to create fullness.
- Place weights or tape while draping design which requires more quantity of fabric. Examples: Wide neckline or

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